

**Berkeley Neighbors for Housing & Climate Action
2024 Candidate Questionnaire**

Candidate Name: [Sophie Hahn](#)

District / Office being sought: [Mayor](#)

1. Berkeley's Housing Element lays out the city's plan for new housing construction through 2031, ensuring the city can meet its Regional Housing Needs Allocation (RHNA) of ~9,000 homes across a range of income levels.

The Housing Element commits Berkeley to a number of major policy changes in order to meet state requirements for affirmatively furthering fair housing, including citywide zoning for "missing middle" housing, a San Pablo Specific Plan, an updated Demolition Ordinance, and upzoning along North Shattuck, Solano, and College Ave, among other items.

What is your view on the Housing Element and these policies?

[I voted for the Housing Element and was very pleased with the outcome of that very long process. It does a good job showing how we can meet our RHNA requirements and Fair Housing goals, which I will work hard to achieve as Mayor of Berkeley.](#)

[I'm particularly pleased with the significant focus on affordable housing, as building and preserving affordable housing is something I am passionate about, and have championed on the City Council. I co-authored and led the campaign to pass 2018's Measure O, the affordable housing bond that has made Berkeley affordable housing boom - more than 1000 new units built or in the pipeline since 2019 - possible. I have also been the Council's foremost advocate for Land Trust-based affordable and cooperative housing, and have secured the necessary funding for projects in my district and throughout Berkeley.](#)

[Missing Middle is underway, and I voted to move it forward. Staff will return to Council an updated version later this fall. Adding gentle density in formerly R-1 areas \(now zoned for 2 units + 2 ADUs by State action\) is a great way to get more - hopefully family-oriented - housing throughout Berkeley's neighborhoods.](#)

[I look forward to the San Pablo Specific Plan process, which has just been initiated, and support the goals. Community process has just begun and I think in particular in a neighborhood that was formerly redlined and is experiencing continued rapid](#)

gentrification, it's important that we take community input before offering specific solutions.

I wrote the item to study upzoning on Shattuck, Solano and College Avenue, the last corridors that haven't been rezoned.

<https://berkeleyca.gov/sites/default/files/documents/2023-05-23%20Item%2037%20Housing%20Element%20%20District%205.pdf>

I support adding density along all corridors, especially in high resource and formerly redlined areas such as North Shattuck and Solano, in my district, and College Avenue in District 8. I am very proud to have already achieved an affordable housing project on Solano Avenue, providing family-sized units less than a block from Thousand Oaks Elementary - where Kamala Harris attended elementary school.

What are the most important things we need to do to implement the City's Housing Element?

Berkeley has already upzoned most corridors, the downtown, and recently upzoned the Southside student district. We have referrals to upzone the remaining corridors and implement Missing Middle in the pipeline. Berkeley's housing element showed we already had zoning capacity to meet our RHNA allocation - even before the upzoning we have recently undertaken. With state density bonuses triggered at inclusionary levels below what Berkeley already requires, almost all mid-sized and larger projects are eligible for 50-100% bonuses.

But while zoning is extremely important, it is not singular in producing housing. Despite a huge increase in zoning capacity over the past 15 years, we are not seeing a big uptake on projects in formerly low rise residential neighborhoods, and applications for larger buildings have slowed considerably, after very robust years. My conversations with developers - virtually all Berkeley developers support my campaign – confirm that two issues are constraining the flow of projects at this time: cost of capital, and fears around saturation in the student-oriented housing market, which is where much of Berkeley's recent building boom has been centered.

To successfully implement the City's Housing Element we need to look at financing, incentives, home/property-owner education, permit facilitation, and other means to encourage housing production in low-density (and all) neighborhoods.

Owners of single family, duplex and other smaller properties aren't developers, and taking on big projects can be expensive, complex, and disruptive to residents - whether

owners or residents. Moreover, the turnover of homes in these areas is slow, so opportunities for projects to be achieved at the time they change hands are also few and far between.

For larger projects, generally in commercial districts, I have a number of ideas to address financing issues, and to encourage developers to look at opportunities outside of the downtown and southside student areas. For smaller/middle projects we need outreach and education for homeowners, much better information and resources (for example, I have heard from many people that they don't want to build ADUs because they don't want to be subject to rent control. ADUs are not subject to rent or eviction controls!), creative financing (PACE model?), and other means to encourage owners to undertake projects.

Please discuss your ideas and priorities around:

Missing Middle housing

As a general matter, I support the concept of missing middle housing. Done correctly, it's a great way to add gentle density to neighborhoods that traditionally have been very low density, and where new housing has been virtually non-existent for decades.

The Berkeley City Council recently took significant steps to address middle housing. We voted to provide direction for the creation of a Middle Housing Ordinance with specific amendments. The ordinance exempts the Hillside Overlay Zone and the ES-R District, as recommended by staff, until we can fully review the Fire Department's Evacuation Study to better understand public safety risks.

Outside of these areas, the ordinance includes a maximum density per acre standard, with the following density limits:

- R-1: 40 units/acre (5 units on a 5,000 sq. ft. lot)
- R-1A: 50 units/acre (6 units on a 5,000 sq. ft. lot)
- R-2: 50 units/acre (6 units on a 5,000 sq. ft. lot)
- R-2A: 60 units/acre (7 units on a 5,000 sq. ft. lot)
- MU-R: 60 units/acre (7 units on a 5,000 sq. ft. lot)

The ordinance also regulates the size of a new primary unit, limiting it to no more than half the lot size or a maximum of 2,500 square feet, whichever is greater. Regarding height, the referral sets a maximum of 35 feet or 3 stories, while maintaining the 22 feet lower height limit within 15 feet of the rear property line. Front- and rear-setbacks are combined to total 20 feet, with a minimum of 5 feet for each, providing greater flexibility

for smaller parcels and promoting backyard space. A neighbor notice requirement has also been added, similar to the Accessory Dwelling Unit Ordinance, to ensure that neighbors are informed of development plans.

I will wait to see what staff returns, as well as their analysis of questions raised at Council, and am particularly interested in ensuring both the Council and the public understand the actual ramifications of what we are passing. I want to see visual representations of the kinds of housing and structures the rules might yield, and their relationships to existing structures, to be presented to the Council and the public before voting on final regulations.

San Pablo specific plan

As a general matter I am very interested in upgrading our public realm and supporting small businesses. Berkeley's Downtown and Commercial Areas, Civic Center, Parks, Marina, Streets/Sidewalks, and other "Public Commons" are in desperate need of major investment. I'm committed to transforming Berkeley into a safe and vibrant 21st Century City that prioritizes community gathering, trees and green spaces, local commerce, and active transit. That said, it's crucial to take into consideration that the San Pablo specific plan is in an area of town with lower income and historically marginalized residents. 90% of the brick and mortar businesses there are locally owned. 21% are women owned, and 41% are people of color owned. I want to make sure that these businesses are not disrupted by development and can continue to thrive. As such, it's important to me that the San Pablo specific plan engages the local residents and listens to what they want, to ultimately empower their own self determination.

Zoning for housing in high-resource neighborhoods like North Shattuck, Solano, and College Ave

The item introduced requesting upzoning of North Shattuck, College and Solano Avenues was authored by myself:

<https://berkeleyca.gov/sites/default/files/documents/2023-05-23%20Item%2037%20Housing%20Element%20%20District%205.pdf>

The corridors in these neighborhoods generally include shallower and much smaller lots than on other corridors such as University and San Pablo Avenue. However, they do include some deeper and larger parcels, and some "through lots." Examples of this include the Andronico's and Safeway parcels on Solano and North Shattuck, the Bank of America parcel on North Shattuck, and the gas station and theater parcels on Solano Avenue.

It may be that parcels of different depths or total square footage could be zoned for different heights, as the larger through lots are better able to provide floor plate sizes that can accommodate taller buildings with more units. This would incentivize assembly and merging of parcels, as building opportunity would increase with parcel size, potentially accelerating the creation of larger parcels more likely to accommodate the elevator shafts, multiple stairwells, and other features required of taller buildings – which require larger floor plates to “pencil out.” These are some ideas I have discussed with the Planning Director to address the unique qualities of these corridors. Regarding height, I would try to duplicate what is currently allowed on San Pablo and/or University Avenue - but will wait to see what the study yields in terms of feasibility for the smaller/shallower parcels. Certainly, for larger and deeper parcels, this would be both feasible and equitable.

Strategies to increase affordable housing on these corridors would include all of our existing strategies - inclusionary housing, stand-alone affordable projects, and Land Trust projects like 1685 Solano Avenue.

2. Berkeley’s Climate Action Plan sets forth a goal of 80% reduction in greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions by 2050. Today, the two major sources of GHG emissions in Berkeley are from gas-powered automobiles and natural gas used in buildings.

Berkeley has a variety of plans and programs intended to help address these emissions, including the Electric Mobility Roadmap and the Berkeley Existing Building Electrification Strategy. Other related efforts include the Bicycle Plan and Pedestrian Master Plan, as well as the City’s now-defunct natural gas ban on new buildings. Upcoming policy initiatives include the Berkeley Building Electrification and Just Transition Pilot Program, Measure GG, the Bay Area Air Quality Management District’s regional ban on new NOx-emitting appliances, and more.

- **What is your view on the Climate Action Plan and these strategies?**
- **What are the most important things we need to do to address greenhouse gas emissions?**
- **Please discuss your ideas and priorities around how Berkeley can reduce emissions from transportation and buildings, and how we should align the climate transition with our other goals as a city.**

What is your view on the Climate Action Plan and these strategies?

The **Climate Action Plan** represents Berkeley's blueprint for addressing the existential threat of climate change. Central to the plan is the understanding that tackling emissions requires systemic change—not just individual responsibility. Through comprehensive initiatives like building electrification and clean transportation solutions, Berkeley is setting a national example for what bold, local climate action can achieve. However, the plan also recognizes that the road to carbon neutrality involves more than just policy—it involves partnerships, community engagement, and financial investments to ensure that the transition to clean energy benefits all residents, particularly those historically marginalized or economically disadvantaged. I see the Climate Action Plan not only as a policy framework but as a call to action, and as Mayor I intend to strengthen and expand the strategies it outlines, ensuring Berkeley meets its climate goals in a way that aligns with our values of equity, innovation, and resilience.

What are the most important things we need to do to address greenhouse gas emissions?

Getting rid of gas in our building and transportation sectors is the most important thing we need to do to reduce our GHG emissions, ending our dependence on fossil fuels, and combating climate change. Reducing our food and consumption-based emissions is also important - and these aren't measured in the Climate Action plan at all. Moving to plant-based diets, eating local, and consuming less - of everything - also have significant positive climate impacts.

Please discuss your ideas and priorities around how Berkeley can reduce emissions from transportation and buildings, and how we should align the climate transition with our other goals as a city.

I co-authored Berkeley's historic ban on natural gas in new buildings, a bold initiative that garnered nationwide attention. This trailblazing effort not only inspired state-level bans but also triggered state prohibitions against local bans on gas in new buildings, leading to hearings in a Republican-led Congress about the "importance" of gas stoves (watch here: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kkwXHO_XrkA). Despite the courts striking down our ban, my commitment remains unwavering. I am now collaborating with Berkeley city staff on an innovative strategy modeled after Seattle's Building Emissions Performance Standard (BEPS), aiming to achieve our original environmental goals through alternative means.

Because Berkeley has already significantly reduced GHG emissions from the building sector, and work is in progress on a variety of paths to achieve building electrification,

my first area of focus as Mayor will be on setting ambitious goals and creating actionable plans to reduce GHG emissions from the transportation sector.

I will set a goal to cut gas-powered vehicle trips by at least 50% by 2040, and to create realistic, actionable plans to achieve this goal, without shaming and blaming. Americans have been addicted to cars - not by their own volition, but because of the choices of city planners, traffic engineers, and others who have shaped our patterns of land use and transportation. Telling them they are bad people for being addicted to cars doesn't solve the problem for anyone: my goal is to stop the "sloganeering" and start problem-solving to achieve significant behavior change.

To start, I will prioritize electrification of the City's fleet, transitioning city-owned vehicles to electric to set a strong example and reduce municipal emissions. Transforming streetscapes to make Berkeley a safer and more attractive city to walk and bike in will be crucial. I also plan to deploy EV charging stations across the city to improve equity of access to electric charging opportunities for renters and low-income community members, and to invite all residents, regardless of income, to participate in the transition to cleaner transit.

Our bus system is in financial stress in the wake of the pandemic and reduced ridership, as well as BART. Finding ways to save and augment public transit will be crucial to meeting ambitious transportation needs - and reductions in GHG emissions, as well as exploration of innovative models such as shuttles with real-time route creation capabilities, electric bikes, other electric mobility.

As with the reduction of emissions from the building sector and breaking our dependence on plastics, I hope to blaze a trail in sustainable transportation that will inspire other cities. By collaborating with local businesses, community groups, and regional partners, we can create a comprehensive approach to reducing transportation emissions. Securing funding and grants will ensure these initiatives are financially viable. Prioritizing the transportation sector will significantly reduce Berkeley's carbon footprint, improve residents' quality of life, and set a powerful example for other communities to follow.

3. In your opinion, what was the most important City Council vote on Berkeley's housing crisis in the past four years?

- Briefly describe the issue,
- what you think of the Council's decision,
- and what you would have done had you been on the Council.
- For incumbents, please describe why you voted the way you did, and what you think now about that vote.

In my time on the City Council, I have participated in many important votes on Berkeley's housing crisis. We've rezoned across the City, approved a new Housing Element, rezoned and moved forward new neighborhoods at North Berkeley and Ashby BART, and set aside funding to achieve at least 35% affordability at both of those projects.

I authored and passed landmark initiatives like the Pathways Project to end Homelessness, and Measure P, a progressive surtax on high-value property sales, resulting in an unprecedented 45% reduction in unsheltered homelessness. I also co-authored and passed Measure O, the largest bond measure in Berkeley's history, providing \$135M for affordable housing and resulting in the largest surge in affordable housing production in half a century. In my 14+ years doing land use in Berkeley, I and my ZAB Appointee have approved more than 10,000 new homes for Berkeley. All of this feels very significant!

In the last four years, if I have to pick one thing, I believe the most important vote on Berkeley's housing crisis was our November 14th 2023 vote on Southside upzoning. UC Berkeley's significant increases in student numbers have continued to put pressure on housing throughout Berkeley, and a lack of housing near campus reduces the academic and social experience for students, who benefit from proximity to the campus with its libraries, sports facilities, extracurricular activities, and many other experiences and amenities. I am very hopeful that the significant increase in capacity that we approved - about three times current capacity - will result in significant new student-oriented housing and revitalization of Telegraph Avenue as a pedestrianized mall.

4. In your opinion, what was the most important climate or environmental issue faced by the Berkeley City Council in the last four years?

- Briefly describe the issue,
- what you think of the Council's decision,
- and what you would have done had you been on the Council.
- For incumbents, please describe why you voted the way you did, and what you think now about that vote.

The most important climate and environmental issue faced by the Berkeley City Council in the last four years was the decision to switch every Berkeley electricity customer to 100% renewable energy.

As an activist before joining the City Council, I worked to establish a local clean energy agency able to provide Berkeley with 100% renewable energy - through California's

“Community Choice Aggregation.” With a grassroots movement, we were successful in launching East Bay Community Energy (now Ava Energy).

To offer Berkeley businesses and residents cleaner energy, and to help the City of Berkeley achieve its Climate Action Plan goals, the Berkeley City Council voted to join Ava Community Energy (Ava) in November 2016 - just before I was sworn in. It was a sweet victory for me after almost a decade of community advocacy. EBCE/Ava began serving residential, business, and municipal electricity customers throughout Berkeley in 2018 - starting with 100% clean energy.

In June of 2021, as a Councilmember, I took the incredibly satisfying and impactful step of voting to finally switch every Berkeley electricity customer to 100% renewable energy. *This has resulted in the largest decline in Berkeley’s GHG emissions - ever - even with a 10% increase in our population.* Berkeley’s electricity is now 100% free of fossil fuels.

I continue to be extremely proud of this impactful work, both in the community and as a Councilmember, and wouldn’t change anything about my vote! We have been able to tackle a major contributor to our GHG emissions, and are now focusing on how we can work on the remaining two major sources of emissions: gas powered automobiles and natural gas used in buildings.

5. To achieve its RHNA goals, Berkeley must continue to build homes for all income levels. These new residents will need to travel within Berkeley. Greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions from transportation comprise roughly 60% of total emissions in Berkeley.

How would you ensure that Berkeley continues to reduce GHG emissions while adding new homes?

As I previously mentioned, switching every Berkeley electricity customer to 100% renewable energy has resulted in the largest decline in Berkeley’s GHG emissions ever, even with a 10% increase in our population. This demonstrates that we can balance population growth and our GHG reduction goals.

Because Berkeley has already significantly reduced GHG emissions from the building sector, and work is in progress on a variety of paths to achieve building electrification, **my first area of focus as Mayor will be on setting ambitious goals and creating actionable plans to reduce GHG emissions from the transportation sector.**

Berkeley has varied topography, from relatively flat areas closer to the SF Bay, to steep hills. Our community also spans many ages, life stages, and life circumstances. I will set

a goal to cut gas-powered vehicle trips by at least 50% by 2040, and to create realistic, actionable plans to achieve this goal. Americans have been addicted to cars - not by their own volition, but because of the choices of city planners, traffic engineers, and others who have shaped our patterns of land use and transportation. Telling them they are bad people for being addicted to cars doesn't solve the problem for anyone: my goal is to stop the shaming and start problem-solving to achieve significant behavior change - which is what it will take to get people to substitute some - or all - of their vehicle trips with public transit, bikes/electric mobility, or walking.

To start, I will prioritize electrification of the City's fleet, transitioning city-owned vehicles to electric to set a strong example – and reduce municipal emissions. Transforming streetscapes to make Berkeley a safer and more attractive city to walk and bike in will also be crucial, as well as deploying EV charging stations across the city - to improve equity of access to electric charging opportunities for renters and low-income community members, and empower all residents, regardless of income, to participate in the transition to cleaner transit. AC Transit and BART face dire prospects in the wake of the pandemic and reduced ridership. Finding ways to save, and augment, public transit will also be crucial to meeting ambitious transportation needs - and reductions in GHG emissions, as well as exploration of innovative models such as shuttles with real-time route creation capabilities, electric bikes, other electric mobility, and more.

An adoption of plant based diets, enabling and practicing urban agriculture, ending fossil fuels in buildings, increasing tree canopy, and promoting a “share economy” will also all be key to reducing GHG emissions as Berkeley builds new homes and our population increases.

Plant Based Diets. Transitioning to a plant-based diet and reducing consumption of meat, in particular beef and other red meats, is critical to reducing GHG emissions. During my time on the City Council, I authored two items, *Accelerating the City of Berkeley's Transition to Plant-Based Foods* and the *Good Food Purchasing Program Resolution*, to support this transition within the City organization, and in the community.

Ending Fossil Fuels in Buildings: I co-authored Berkeley's historic ban on natural gas in new buildings, a bold initiative that garnered nationwide attention. This trailblazing effort not only inspired copy-cat legislation in cities and states across the US, but also triggered state prohibitions against local bans on gas in new buildings, leading to hearings in a Republican-led Congress about the “importance” of gas stoves (watch here: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kqwXHO_XrkA). Despite the courts striking down our ban, my commitment remains unwavering. I am now collaborating with Berkeley city staff on an innovative strategy modeled after Seattle's Building Emissions Performance Standard (BEPS), aiming to achieve our original environmental goals

through alternative means.

Enabling and Practicing Urban Ag: Before I was elected to the City Council I founded a backyard urban farm and “CSA” with a leading expert on Urban Ag, Willow Rosenthal. We set out to prove that backyard farming can be a regular source of fresh produce for urban families, and a viable source of income for emerging urban farmers, while significantly reducing carbon impacts.

The Berkeley Basket, now encompassing three local backyards, has been operating for more than 12 years and provides organically grown, zero-mile produce for approximately 50 individuals throughout the 8-9 month growing season. This contrasts with supermarket produce, which travels an average of 1,200 miles before reaching customers.

When we founded the Berkeley Basket (previously Shattuck Gardens), we learned that selling and trading homegrown produce was against the law in Berkeley. We wrote a new Urban Ag law to allow the sale and trade of fresh produce and eggs in Berkeley’s residential areas, and now-Mayor Arreguin, then a City Councilmember, carried and passed the legislation at the City Council.

More recently, as an elected Councilmember, I worked with Mayor Arreguin to expand urban ag legislation to enable food production and sales in every zone in Berkeley - residential, commercial, and manufacturing. I also co-sponsored the Berkeley Food Utility and Access Resilience Measure (FARM), which facilitates city-supported, large-scale food production within the City of Berkeley through economic incentives, partnerships, and innovative urban agriculture techniques.

Miyawaki Forests: Forests provide shade, cooling, habitat, carbon sequestration, sound buffers, and support mental health - among other benefits. To bring forests back into the urban core, I authored and have championed legislation to plant Miyawaki “pocket” forests in Berkeley - a first for any municipality in the United States. These small, “supercharged” forests, planted according to the Miyawaki method and comprised of native species, grow quickly and can be planted in small pockets throughout the urban core. My legislation has funded two pilot forests for the City of Berkeley, to learn best practices before deploying these forests across the City. Both initial locations are in lower-income neighborhoods with less tree canopy and poor air quality, where the benefits of re-forestation are most urgently needed.

Berkeley Public Library SHARE initiative: Achieving Zero Waste and reducing GHG emissions requires us to reduce consumption. Public Libraries have long been in the “sharing business,” and are the perfect locus for facilitating the sharing of a broader range of occasionally-used items than books and media. Berkeley’s public library was one of the first in the nation to expand its collections to include tools, part of a movement in the 1970s to support home improvements for low-income communities. Expanding on the library’s traditional lending role, I introduced and passed legislation to transform Berkeley’s Tool Lending Library into a comprehensive Share Hub for the community. In-house lending collections will be expanded to include many more categories of occasionally-used items, and the library will become a clearing-house for rental, share, and freecycle opportunities in the community.

6. Walking and biking presents opportunities to help Berkeley residents reduce their GHG emissions, but safety concerns can be a major deterrent. Of the two competing street paving measures on the ballot this November, one of the major differences between the two is the approach to funding safety improvements for walking and biking.

Measure EE would provide safety funding only for traffic calming on bicycle boulevards and major pedestrian projects identified in the Pedestrian Plan. Measure FF would provide funding to implement safety measures throughout the city, based on existing plans.

What is your perspective on how we should address pedestrian and cyclist safety on our streets?

Encouraging walking, bicycling, public transit, and other alternatives to automobiles is crucial for creating a sustainable and vibrant city. As such, we must prioritize pedestrian and cyclist safety as we design and implement plans to improve our streets and sidewalks.

Building robust bike networks is essential. We need safe, accessible, and interconnected bike lanes that allow cyclists to navigate the city with ease. Expanding bike/pedestrian boulevards and implementing one-way streets - with the “other half” devoted to bikes and electric mobility, can provide generous, safe and appropriate facilities for people of all ages and abilities.

Implementing “Complete Streets” is another critical component. As we pave and maintain our streets, we must incorporate features that support all modes of transportation. This includes dedicated bike lanes, wider sidewalks, pedestrian

crossings, and traffic calming measures. Designing streets to accommodate everyone makes walking, biking, and public transit more attractive and practical options for residents.

Addressing specific barriers that different groups face when adopting alternative modes of transportation is crucial. For seniors and those with disabilities, we must ensure that sidewalks, crossings, and transit stops are accessible and safe. For families with young children, amenities like protected bike lanes and stroller-friendly sidewalks are essential. Promoting a culture shift towards sustainable transportation through public awareness campaigns, community events, and incentives is also vital.

What is your perspective on these two measures?

Measures EE and FF fundamentally both agree on the same thing: we need to improve Berkeley's streets and pedestrian and bike safety. Ultimately, both measures will provide more than ample funds to achieve both our paving and street safety goals. Much of the City's existing paving dollars - doubled during my time on the City Council - are general fund dollars that can be deployed in any way Council approves.

I'm disappointed that the two groups now coming forward couldn't agree on a single version, and that critiques and demands from individuals in both of these groups resulted in the failure of 2022's Measure L - which included \$200M for affordable housing as well. Opposition to Measure L set back the cause of achieving street safety by several years and is bringing Berkeley's progress on affordable housing to an abrupt halt. The continued failure of community members/groups to achieve consensus does not bode well for smooth sailing ahead, no matter which proposal garners the most votes.

Because Berkeley's general fund allocations towards paving and street rehabilitation, always deployed in accordance with the City's complete streets policies, are fungible and can be used in numerous ways to supplement funds from an eventual paving measure, the differences between the measures are largely symbolic, other than one costing taxpayers a little more or less than the other. *Either measure will provide ample funds to improve the City's pavement conditions and achieve Vision Zero and other important safety goals.* For this reason, and because I cannot reward any group that killed critically important funding for affordable housing (via Measure L), I have not endorsed either measure.

7. Berkeley has a long history of using zoning, restrictive covenants and redlining to achieve racial and economic segregation. This history continues to shape Berkeley today.

Recent research by the Turner Center at UC Berkeley suggests that inclusionary zoning requirements, which mandate on-site restricted affordable housing in new developments, may have the effect of reducing overall housing construction, including the production of affordable units. However, on-site affordable housing can also be an effective tool for desegregating neighborhoods.

What is your perspective on how Berkeley should use inclusionary zoning requirements, versus other affordable housing development options (such as in-lieu fees)?

I strongly support public financing of affordable housing, which is why I championed Measure O, and championed Measure L. I'm deeply disappointed that the regional housing bond didn't go forward in 2024, and that we did not put a local housing bond on the ballot - in the wake of Measure L's failure to achieve the 67% threshold.

I strongly support mixed-income projects and prefer that affordable units be built on-site in Berkeley, using bond financing and in lieu fees (developers have the option to do on site, fee, or a combination) for all-affordable projects. On-site affordable units ensure that affordable housing is built simultaneously with market-rate units and is distributed across neighborhoods, promoting economic diversity and preventing the concentration of low-income housing in specific areas. This approach aligns with Berkeley's goals of fostering fair housing and inclusive communities.

In-lieu fees, while they offer a way for developers to contribute to affordable housing without building on-site, can lead to delays in the actual construction of affordable units. While the funds from these fees can be pooled to create larger affordable projects, the immediate impact on housing diversity is lessened.

To fund all-affordable projects, I prefer to raise bond financing as was the case with Measure O. By combining on-site development and bond financing, we get "the best of both worlds," dispersed and concentrated affordable housing, at all levels, throughout Berkeley.

Berkeley's approach should balance inclusionary zoning requirements and other affordable housing development options based on feasibility. While I prefer on-site affordable units for desegregating neighborhoods and ensuring mixed-income developments, I recognize that certain projects or economic conditions might make other strategies, such as in-lieu fees, more practical. As long as we continue to monitor

the feasibility of the City's inclusionary and in-lieu requirements via required feasibility studies, I believe we can maintain a balance that supports both the immediate need for affordable housing and the long-term goals for the City to build as much new housing as possible.

8. Many of the highest income neighborhoods in Berkeley are also in the Hillside Overlay, portions of which are in the California Very High Fire Hazard Severity Zone (CalFire VHFHSZ). How should we balance fire risk with affirmatively furthering fair housing?

Berkeley's geography presents unique challenges, particularly in areas like the Hillside Overlay, which are both high-income and located in the Very High Fire Hazard Severity Zone (VHFHSZ). I strongly believe that we must address the critical need for fire safety without abandoning our commitment to fair housing and desegregation. Ensuring both safety and housing equity in these areas requires thoughtful, balanced policies.

I support unit-neutral caps on development in the Very High Fire Hazard Severity Zone that limit the total bulk/square footage of "built" structures (including housing, garages, sheds, etc.) while still allowing for up to four units within that built footprint. Fire doesn't care how many units there are; it just eats flammable materials, including all built structures. With very limited egress in Berkeley's VHFHSZs, steep terrain, and no reliable public transit, one has to assume there will be increased vehicles with increased bedrooms and units. For this reason, I do not support more than four units per parcel in Berkeley's VHFHSZs.

Additionally, we must be cautious about how these decisions impact low- and middle-income residents. For example, while it's important to limit total development in High Fire Hazard areas, we should prioritize affordable housing and incentivize wildfire-resilient building materials and designs for development that does take place. Incorporating green building standards and promoting safe, affordable housing in other parts of the city can help offset any limitations in the hills while maintaining our commitment to housing equity.

I've worked closely with Berkeley Fire on all of our plans to address catastrophic fire, including implementation of the Zone system, and signing thousands of people up for Nixle and other alert systems, so people can be called to evacuate in an orderly manner. My office took the lead in helping Berkeley Fire run an evacuation drill for the entire North Berkeley hills. I've written legislation to guide all of Berkeley's wildfire preparedness and evacuation efforts, and led the effort to pass a special tax, 2018's Measure FF, to pay for critical fire safety planning, implementation, training, and equipment.

2018's Measure FF ensures we have the funding needed for critical fire safety measures, but we can—and should—align those efforts with fair housing goals by planning for safe, affordable housing across all parts of Berkeley. By working closely with community members, fire safety experts, and housing advocates, we can develop a balanced approach that protects all residents, particularly those who are most vulnerable, while ensuring that housing in Berkeley remains accessible, inclusive, and equitable.